

Learning How to Learn: Outside Pressure

学会学习：外部压力

Theme: 学习方法与教育 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

An **inspection** in the spring brought outside pressure of a **very** specific kind. A **classified** report on the language programme in the **tower** called the map's claims "a decorative **curtain**". "It is not **false**," the inspector said, "but it is not **success** either. **Unless** you can show a real **increase** in comprehension, the funding goes elsewhere."

The students had begun to **complain**, and the complaint was **realistic**; it stung. A **movie** about a **miracle** teacher had made the public expect miracles, and the group had to explain that a quiet change is not a **disappearance**. "We cannot **motivate** a funder with **beauty**," Maya said. "We have to **classify** what we **actually** do." The **silence** in the room was the loudest thing in it.

The **damage** was done to their timeline **rather** than to their data. A report had to be written in **prose**, with no room for a **lame** excuse; every **verb**, **adverb**, and **preposition** **would** be examined. "Do not **elevate** the language above the evidence," Professor Zhao said. "**Converse** with the reader, do not **narrate** at them."

The inspector was **intelligent**, and her intelligence was not the **problem**; the **problem** was the **imaginary** reader she represented. A **vacant** office, a **mix** of old and new rules, and a **devil** of a deadline made the work harder. The **disappointment** was real, and the **ruin** of the old plan was complete. "I **would rather** be honest than **wide**," Lin wrote. "**There** is a **reason** we keep the ugly numbers."

Awareness grew slowly, and **so** did the paperwork. The coordinator overheard two students in the corridor and put their sentence at the top of the report: "It is not **easy**, but it is **really** ours." That line did more than the **thousand** figures; **six** weeks later, **twenty** pages of additional material were requested, and the **coordinate** of their next move was **actually** simple: publish everything, including the failure. "The **hindrance** was never the method," she said. "It was the **deceptive** quiet of the **middle class** of donors." A **regretful** paragraph replaced it, and the group united behind one sentence: a small true thing, repeated. **However**, **much** of the **paper** was **already** written, and **sometimes** a single sheet **could** carry a **speech**. They **could mean** it, which was not nothing.

中文翻译

春天的一次检查带来了非常具体的外部压力。一份关于这座塔楼语言项目的机密报告把地图的主张称为“一块装饰性的帷幕”。“它不是假的，”检查员说，“但也不是成功。除非你们能证明理解力有真实的提高，资金就会流向别处。”

这项抱怨是现实的，也刺痛了他们。一部关于奇迹教师的电影让公众期待奇迹，而小组必须解释：一种安静的变化并不是消失。“我们无法用美来激励出资人，”曼雅说，“我们必须把我们实际做的事分类说清。”屋里最响的东西就是那份沉默。

受损的是时间表，而不是数据。报告必须用散文写成，没有留给他们一个蹩脚借口的空间；每一个动词、副词和介词都会被审查。“不要把语言抬到证据之上，”赵教授说，“要与读者交谈，而不是对他们叙述。”

问题不是检查员的智力，而是她所代表的那个想象中的读者。一间空置的办公室、一套新旧规则混杂的制度，以及一个魔鬼般的截止日期，让工作更难。失望是真实的，旧计划的废墟也彻底落定。“我宁可诚实，也不要宽泛，”林伟写道，“我们保留那些难看的数字是有原因的。”

意识慢慢增长，文书工作也是。协调员在走廊里无意中听到两名学生的话，把他们的句子放在了报告的最前面：“这不容易，但它真的是我们的。”这句话比一千个数字更有用；六周后，二十页补充材料被要求提交，而他们下一步行动的坐标其实很简单：把一切公布出来，包括失败。“障碍从来不是方法，”她说，“而是中产阶级捐赠者那种具有欺骗性的安静。”一段遗憾的文字取代了它，小组团结在一句话背后：一件小而真的事，重复下去。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
very 'veri POS: a	a. 真正的, 恰好的, 十足的, 特有的; adv. 非常, 完全 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. precisely as stated; r. used as intensifiers; 'real' is sometimes used informally for 'really'; 'rattling'...
really 'ri:li POS: adv	adv. 实际上, 真实地, 实在 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in accordance with truth or fact or reality; r in actual fact; r in fact (used as intensifiers or sentence mo...
reason 'ri:zn POS: n	n. 理由, 原因, 理智, 道理, 前提, 理性; vt. 说服, 推论, 辩论; vi. 推论, 劝说, 思考 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a rational motive for a belief or action; n. an explanation of the cause of some phenomenon; n. the capacity...
actually 'æktʃuəli POS: adv	adv. 事实上, 竟然, 如今, 现在 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in actual fact; r. used to imply that one would expect the fact to be the opposite of that stated; surprisi...
movie 'mu:vi POS: n	n. 电影 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a form of entertainment that enacts a story by sound and a sequence of images giving the illusion of conti...
success sək'ses POS: n	n. 成功, 成就, 胜利 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an event that accomplishes its intended purpose; n. an attainment that is successful; n. a state of prosperi...
unless ,ən'les POS: conj	conj. 除非; prep. 除...之外 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: conj. Upon any less condition than (the fact or thing stated; in the sentence or clause which follows); if...
damage 'dæmɪdʒ POS: n	n. 损害, 伤害; v. 损害 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the occurrence of a change for the worse; n. loss of military equipment; n. the act of damaging something or...
speech spi:tʃ POS: n	n. 演讲, 说话, 谈话, 言语, 引语, 民族语言; [医] 言语, 语言 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (language) communication by word of mouth; n. something spoken; n. the exchange of spoken words
silence 'saɪləns POS: n	n. 沉默, 无声, 静寂, 湮没, 无声息; vt. 使缄默; interj. 安静 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being silent (as when no one is speaking); n. the absence of sound; v. keep from expression, fo...
beauty 'bju:ti POS: n	n. 美, 美人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the qualities that give pleasure to the senses; n. an outstanding example of its kind
mix mɪks POS: n	n. 混合物, 混乱, 糊涂; vt. 使混合, 弄混, 使结合, 混淆; vi. 相混合, 交往, 参与 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a commercially prepared mixture of dry ingredients; n. an event that combines things in a mixture; n. the ac...
complain kəm'pleɪn POS: v	v. 抱怨, 抗议, 控诉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. express complaints, discontent, displeasure, or unhappiness; v. make a formal accusation; bring a formal ch...
tower 'taʊə POS: n	n. 塔, 高楼, 堡垒; vi. 高耸, 翱翔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure taller than its diameter; can stand alone or be attached to a larger building
false fo:ls POS: a	a. 错误的, 虚伪的, 假的, 不老实的; adv. 不准确地, 欺诈地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not in accordance with the fact or reality or actuality; s. arising from error; s. erroneous and usually acc...
awareness ə'weənɪs POS: n	n. 意识, 认识; [计] 识别, 议定, 明白 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. having knowledge of; n. state of elementary or undifferentiated consciousness
curtain 'kɜ:tən POS: n	n. 帐, 幕, 窗帘; vt. 装帘子于, 遮蔽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. hanging cloth used as a blind (especially for a window); n. any barrier to communication or vision; v. provi...
inspection ɪn'spekʃən POS: n	n. 检验, 检查, 视察; [医] 检查, 视察, 监督, 望诊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a formal or official examination
miracle 'mɪrəkl POS: n	n. 奇迹, 奇事 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any amazing or wonderful occurrence; n. a marvellous event manifesting a supernatural act of a divine agent
motivate 'məʊtɪveɪt POS: vt	vt. 给与动机, 刺激, 提高...的学习欲望, 促动; [经] 促动, 激发, 激励 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give an incentive for action

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
devil 'deɪvəl POS: n	n. 魔鬼; vt. 折磨, 戏弄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an evil supernatural being; n. a word used in exclamations of confusion; v. coat or stuff with a spicy paste
realistic riə'lɪstɪk POS: a	a. 现实的, 逼真的, 现实主义的, 实在论的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. aware or expressing awareness of things as they really are; a. of or relating to the philosophical doctrine...
intelligent ɪn'telɪdʒənt POS: a	a. 聪明的, 智能的, 了解的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having the capacity for thought and reason especially to a high degree; s. possessing sound knowledge; s. en...
unite ju:'naɪt POS: vi	vi. 联合, 接合, 混合; vt. 使联合, 统一, 使粘合, 使结合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. act in concert or unite in a common purpose or belief; v. have or possess in combination; v. bring together...
disappointment .dɪsə'pɔɪntmənt POS: n	n. 失望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of dissatisfaction that results when your expectations are not realized; n. an act (or failure to...
classify 'klæsɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 分类, 归类, 分等; [建] 分类, 分级, 分粒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. arrange or order by classes or categories; v. declare unavailable, as for security reasons
ruin ruɪn POS: n	n. 毁灭, 推翻, 废墟; vi. 毁灭, 衰败, 破坏, 破产, 堕落; vt. 使毁灭, 毁坏, 使破产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an irrecoverable state of devastation and destruction; n. a ruined building; n. an event that results in des...
verb vɜ:b POS: n	n. 动词; [计] 动词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the word class that serves as the predicate of a sentence; n. a content word that denotes an action, occur...
coordinate kəu'b:dɪneɪt POS: n	n. 同等的人(或物), 坐标; a. 同等的, 并列的; v. (使)协调 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a number that identifies a position relative to an axis; v. bring into common action, movement, or conditio...
elevate 'elɪveɪt POS: vt	vt. 举起, 提拔, 鼓舞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v give a promotion to or assign to a higher position; v raise from a lower to a higher position; v raise in ran...
prose prəʊz POS: n	n. 散文; v. 写散文; a. 散文的, 平凡的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. ordinary writing as distinguished from verse; n. matter of fact, commonplace, or dull expression
vacant 'veɪkənt POS: a	a. 空的, 空白的, 空虚的, 空闲的, 茫然的, 空缺的; [法] 空的, 空虚的, 闲眼的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. void of thought or knowledge; s. without an occupant or incumbent
imaginary ɪ'mædʒɪnəri POS: a	a. 想像的, 虚构的, 假想的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n (mathematics) a number of the form a+bi where a and b are real numbers and i is the square root of -1; s not...
disappearance .dɪsə'piərəns POS: n	n. 看不见, 失踪, 消失 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of leaving secretly or without explanation; n. the event of passing out of sight; n. ceasing to exist
overhear .əʊvə'hɪə POS: vt	vt. 无意中听到, 偷听 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v hear, usually without the knowledge of the speakers
classified 'klæsɪfaɪd POS: a	a. 分类的, 被归入某类的, 被指定为机密的; [建] 分了类的, 分了级的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. arranged into classes; a. official classification of information or documents; withheld from general circul...
lame leɪm POS: a	a. 跛足的, 僵痛的, 不完全的, 金属薄板, 不知内情的人; vi. 变跛; vt. 使成残废, 使无用 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fabric interwoven with threads of metal
narrate nə'reɪt POS: v	v. 说故事, 说明, 叙述 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. provide commentary for a film, for example
converse kən've:s POS: n	n. 相反的事物, 倒, 逆向; a. 相反的, 逆向的, 颠倒的; vi. 交谈, 谈话 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a proposition obtained by conversion; v. carry on a conversation; s. of words so related that one reverses t...
deceptive dɪ'septɪv POS: a	a. 迷惑的, 虚伪的, 欺诈的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. causing one to believe what is not true or fail to believe what is true; s. designed to deceive or mislead...
hindrance 'hɪndrəns POS: n	n. 妨害, 障碍, 阻碍物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something immaterial that interferes with or delays action or progress; n. any obstruction that impedes or...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
adverb 'ædvə:b POS: n	n. 副词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the word class that qualifies verbs or clauses; n. a word that modifies something other than a noun
regretful ri'gretful POS: a	a. 惋惜的, 遗憾的, 抱歉的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. feeling or expressing regret or sorrow or a sense of loss over something done or undone
preposition ,prepe'ziʃən POS: n	n. 前置词, 介词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a function word that combines with a noun or pronoun or noun phrase to form a prepositional phrase that ca...
middle class phonetic unavailable POS: review required	中产阶级; [经] 中级 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.